Activity 6: Airbnb: Recover Trust Across a Service Ecosystem

Course C233

Objective

Champion the service brand during failure and recovery

Documented real-event basis

Airbnb describes itself as a community built around connection, enabled by hosts offering stays and experiences to guests through its platform.

Scenario

A Singapore experience-booking platform faces a same-day provider cancellation that disrupts a family's celebration. The platform, provider and payment partner must coordinate recovery.

Primary source

https://news.airbnb.com/about-us/

Training assumptions

• The booking platform, incident, family and financial amounts are fictional and not an Airbnb event.

• The booking value is S$480 and an alternative provider is available at S$620 two hours later.

• Frontline agents may approve S$150 without escalation; safety and fraud flags require specialist review.

• The promise is 'Local moments, made dependable'.

Questions

1. What outcome, process and interaction fairness does the customer need?

2. Who owns the recovery when value is co-created by several parties?

3. What authority and guardrails should frontline employees have?

4. What evidence would show confidence is restored and the system improved?

Expected output

Service-recovery playbook with authority matrix and three customer messages

Acceptance test

The playbook protects outcome/process/interaction fairness, assigns ecosystem ownership, respects authority limits, and closes with a verified improvement action.